handed in the six episodes by mid-April and received our final payment by the end of the month.

Things had been smooth so far but there was an unexpected twist in the tale. The Times Network had apparently signed a contract with Facebook which required them to scale down the duration of each episode and have them uploaded on the network's Facebook page. When we passed on this requirement, the network assigned another firm the responsibility of scaling down the content. In the process, they also scaled down the six 60-minute episodes to six 30-minute TV episodes. This was a departure from the original, puritan version and left out much more than it retained. As the writer and producer, I was deeply saddened.

But every cloud has a silver lining; towards the end of November 2018, Maroof appeared in my office one afternoon with an offer that was too tempting to refuse. Bloomsbury had decided to commission us to jointly write a book on Kashmir. Since I had already done all the research and had written the scripts for several documentaries on the subject, it would not be difficult to restructure them all into a book. Also, the limitations of documentary filmmaking in India, with the measly budgets, prevents the filmmaker from exploring the depths of the subject matter. Writing the book would not only prove to be a healing experience from the Times Now fiasco, but also enable me to do full justice to a story that had never been comprehensively reported on in the public media. Co-authoring this book has been a very enjoyable and fulfilling experience. Our research brought to light the hard reality of Pakistan's deep dissatisfaction over inheriting a 'moth-eaten' country from the British. They had to play out their hateful agenda by making India bleed with a thousand cuts. Today, with their new overlords—the Chinese—the Pakistanis are continuing with this strategy and because of the reasons argued in this book, no amount of candlelight marches are ever going to make them change their policy. Militancy in Kashmir is here to stay; it will only be controlled by the joint forces of Pakistan and China. Both Pakistan and China fear India's soft power and need to tie India down with their military power. Only time will tell if my assessment is accurate.